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BRANCH : COMPUTER SCIENCE

YEAR : 2025 – 2029

COURSE TITLE : DIGITAL LITERACY

COURSE CODE : CSE0001

DATE OF SUBMISSION : 31 MARCH 2026

Introduction

Digital literacy has become an essential skill for students in the modern academic environment. This project focuses on developing a comprehensive understanding of digital tools, professional communication, and cyber safety practices. The aim of this project is to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio through various tasks such as creating an infographic, setting up professional profiles, exploring coding platforms, drafting professional emails, and studying cybercrime awareness. The concept of DigitalBuddy was introduced as a student-friendly application idea to guide learners in improving their digital skills. Through this project, I explored practical tools and platforms that enhance productivity, communication, and online security. The tasks also helped in understanding responsible digital behavior and maintaining a professional online presence.

Task 1 Write-up

For Task 1, I created a digital literacy awareness infographic using Canva. The infographic explains the meaning of digital literacy, safe internet practices, and the importance of maintaining a professional online presence. The design includes icons, short descriptions, and a structured layout to make it visually appealing and easy to understand. I used Canva because it provides ready-made templates and simple drag-and-drop features. The infographic highlights useful tools for students such as GitHub, LinkedIn, and Google Workspace. One interesting part of the task was selecting relevant content and organizing it in a single-page format. The challenging aspect was balancing visuals and text to avoid overcrowding the design. This task helped me understand how visual communication can effectively spread awareness about digital skills.

Task 2 Write-up

In Task 2, I created and updated my professional digital profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and HackerRank. GitHub was used to host my project repository and showcase my work. LinkedIn was updated with my educational details including my degree, branch, and expected graduation year. HackerRank was chosen to practice coding skills and explore beginner challenges. These platforms serve different purposes: GitHub for project hosting, LinkedIn for professional

networking, and HackerRank for skill development. Over the next four years, I plan to regularly update my GitHub with projects, connect with professionals on LinkedIn, and improve coding skills through HackerRank. This task helped me understand the importance of building a professional online presence early in my academic journey.

Task 3 Write-up

For Task 3, I explored coding and collaboration platforms. I created a HackerRank account and completed a beginner-level coding challenge. This helped me understand problem-solving and coding practice environments. Additionally, I created a Google Form consisting of five questions related to digital literacy awareness. The form included multiple-choice and short-answer questions. I also viewed responses in Google Sheets. These tools help in academic collaboration, data collection, and assessment. Practicing coding challenges improves logical thinking, while Google Forms can be used for quizzes and surveys. This task provided hands-on experience with tools that will support my academic activities and collaborative learning.

Task 4 Write-up

Digital communication plays a crucial role in academic and professional settings. In this task, I drafted two professional emails and created a social media etiquette checklist. Poor digital communication can lead to misunderstandings, missed opportunities, or negative impressions. For example, sending an email without a subject line or proper greeting may appear unprofessional. Proper etiquette includes clear subject lines, respectful tone, and structured content. This task helped me understand how professional communication improves credibility and effectiveness.

Task 5 Write-up

For Task 5, I researched UPI fraud as a common cybercrime affecting students. I learned how attackers use fake links, OTP requests, and phishing messages to steal money. This research highlighted the importance of verifying sources and avoiding suspicious links. One surprising aspect was how easily users fall victim to fake payment requests. As a result, I will adopt safer habits such as verifying

payment requests and avoiding sharing OTPs. This task increased my awareness of online threats and preventive measures.

Conclusion

This project helped me develop practical digital literacy skills including profile building, professional communication, and cyber safety awareness. The DigitalBuddy app idea integrates these features into a single platform. Overall, the project enhanced my understanding of responsible digital behavior and professional online presence.